006. Al-An'aam ~ The Cattle

165 Ayaat (Makki)

FOCUS

OBJECTIONS OF THE MAKKANS TO MONOTHEISM AND DIVINITY'S REPLY
PRACTICAL IMPLICATIONS OF TAWHEED
LIVESTOCK DEDICATED TO DEITIES AND INNOVATIONS IN THE NAME OF DIVINITY

DID YOU KNOW?

This is the longest Makkan sura possibly revealed as one discourse with 70,000 angels. It takes its name from the discussion of the self-imposed restrictions placed by the Makkans on the consumption of cattle.

SELECTED AYAAT

6:59	Keys of unseen treasure with Allah
6:63	Who delivers from danger?
6:141	Extravagance
6:160	Good deeds
6:162	Say: surely my prayer and my sacrifice and my life and my death are (all) for Allah, the Lord of the worlds.

NARRATIVE

THE CHAPTER BEGINS WITH A POWERFUL STATEMENT INTRODUCING ALLAH AS THE UNIVERSAL CREATOR AND HIS TOTAL POWER. AFTER REJECTING THE EXCUSES OF THE MAKKANS FOR NOT TAKING HEED OF THE PROPHET, ALLAH REPLIES TO THE OBJECTIONS OF THE MAKKANS REMINDING THEM OF THE FATE OF PREVIOUS GENERATIONS WHO IGNORED DIVINE MESSENGERS. IT CONSOLES THE PROPHET IN THE FACE OF THE REJECTION BY THE MAKKANS SPECIFYING HIS ABSOLUTE KNOWLEDGE OF EVERYTHING AND BEING THE ONE WHO DELIVERS FROM DISTRESS

PROPHET IBRAHEEM'S DISCOURSE ABOUT WORSHIPPING ANYTHING OTHER THAN ALLAH WHETHER IT BE THE STARS, MOON AND SUN IS FOLLOWED BY REFLECTION ON ALLAH AS THE CREATOR AND GIVER OF BOTH LIFE AND DEATH.

A DIRECTIVE TO EAT MEAT ON WHICH ALLAH'S NAME IS MENTIONED (HALAL) IS FOLLOWED BY A COMPARISON OF THE CONSEQUENCES OF BELIEF IN DIVINITY (SECURITY AND PEACE) VERSUS THE HUMILIATION AND AGITATION SUFFERED BY THOSE WHO COVER UP THE TRUTH.

THE CHAPTER THEN ADDRESSES THE INNOVATIVE RESTRICTIONS MADE UP BY THE MAKKANS REGARDING THE CONSUMPTION OF CERTAIN KINDS OF MEATS COUNTERING IT WITH A SIMPLE SET OF DIETARY LAWS AND A CONCISE LIST OF DIVINE COMMANDS AND PROHIBITIONS.

FINALLY IT CONCLUDES WITH VERSES ON MONOTHEISTIC BELIEF AND UTTER DEVOTION TO DIVINITY IN PRAYER, SACRIFICE, LIFE AND DEATH.